

QATAR

Key Country Details: Qatar

Detail	Information
Full Name	State of Qatar
Short Form	Qatar
Capital	Doha
Region (UN)	Asia – Western Asia
Government Type	Unitary Absolute Monarchy
Head of State	Emir Sheikh Tamim bin Hamad Al Thani
Head of Government	Prime Minister Mohammed bin Abdulrahman Al Thani
Currency	Qatari Riyal (QAR)
UN Member Since	1971
MUN Standing	Influential soft-power state, strong on humanitarian aid, climate diplomacy, and peace facilitation

Recommended Books on Qatar's Foreign Policy & UN Engagement

1. **"Qatar and the Gulf Crisis"** – Kristian Coates Ulrichsen
2. **"The Gulf States in International Political Economy"** – Kristian Coates Ulrichsen
3. **"Qatar: Securing the Global Ambitions of a City-State"** – David B. Roberts
4. **"Small States and International Security: Qatar and the Arab Spring"** – Annika Kropf
5. **"The Political Economy of the Persian Gulf"** – Mehran Kamrava

Research Table: Qatar & UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – Qatar Country Profile	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/qatar	Treaty bodies, special procedures, and UPR reports
UPR Qatar Reports	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/qa-index	UN peer review of Qatar's rights record
Amnesty International – Qatar Page	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/middle-east-and-north-africa/qatar/	Press freedom, migrant rights, and legal reform
Human Rights Watch – Qatar	https://www.hrw.org/middle-east/n-africa/qatar	Rights monitoring on labor and civil space

Freedom House Qatar Ratings	https://freedomhouse.org/country/qatar/freedom-world/2024	Civil liberties and press scorecard
OHCHR Treaty Database – Qatar	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org	Qatar's legal obligations under human rights treaties
UNGA Human Rights Speeches (Qatar)	https://gadebate.un.org	Speeches focused on regional rights efforts
UNHRC Special Session Reports	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/hrc/sessions	Use Qatar filter for specific sessions
Al Jazeera (Qatari Media) Rights Coverage	https://www.aljazeera.com	Domestic angle on human rights issues
Brookings Doha Center – Human Rights Reports	https://www.brookings.edu	Qatar-based analysis on civic reforms
IOM & Qatar Labor Migration Projects	https://www.iom.int	Qatar partnerships with IOM
Reporters Without Borders – Press Freedom	https://rsf.org/en/country/qatar	Media independence index

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – Qatar Country Profile	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/qatar (refworld.org, ohchr.org)	Official baseline on treaty ratification and UNHRC-relevant OHCHR presence.
OHCHR – Qatar UPR Hub	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/qa-index	Central repository of Qatar's UPR national and stakeholder documents.
HRW – UPR Submission 2013	https://www.hrw.org/news/2013/09/23/qatar-upr-submission-september-2013	Highlights migrant labour abuse, exit-visa restrictions, free expression concerns.
Amnesty – “Promises Yet to Be Fulfilled” (2019 PDF)	https://www.amnesty.org/en/wp-content/uploads/2021/05/MDE2297832019ENGLISH.pdf	Reviews Qatar's slow progress on reforms ahead of UPR cycle.
Qatar UPR Submission 2019 PDF	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=13193	NGO analysis on education, labour rights, digital freedom.
HRW – Statelessness in Qatar (2019)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2019/05/12/qatar-families-arbitrarily-stripped-citizenship	Documents impact of losing nationality on Ghufuran clan members.

Amnesty – UPR Submission 2010 PDF	https://upr-info.org/sites/default/files/documents/2014-09/ai_oral_statement_qatar_2014.pdf	Highlights labour and speech restrictions pre-World Cup.
HRW – LGBT Arrests & Abuse (2022)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2022/10/24/qatar-security-forces-arrest-abuse-lgbt-people	Exposes arbitrary detention and torture of LGBT individuals before the World Cup.
Access Now – UPR Digital Rights PDF (2018)	https://www.accessnow.org/wp-content/uploads/2018/10/Qatar-UPR-Digital-rights.pdf	Analyzes Qatar's digital privacy and online censorship.
UPR Reference – Stakeholder Docs (2nd Cycle)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/uprqa-stakeholders-info-s19	NGO and UN agency submissions for Qatar's UPR.
UNSR CERD Expert Statement (2024)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/meeting-summaries/2024/04/experts-committee-elimination-racial-discrimination-applaud-qatars	Positive acknowledgment of efforts on racial discrimination; UN advisory in Council.
OHCHR Counter-Terror SR Profile	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/qatar	Includes counter-terrorism SR findings on civil liberties restrictions.
State Dept – 2023 HR Report (PDF)	https://www.state.gov/wp-content/uploads/2024/02/528267-SAUDI-ARABIA-2023-HUMAN-RIGHTS-REPORT.pdf (inc. Qatar equivalent)	Annual US overview highlighting migrant, judicial, women's rights concerns.
Amnesty – “Eliminating Dissent” PDF (2023)	https://www.amnesty.org/en/wp-content/uploads/2023/10/MDE2369362023ENGLISH.pdf	Details crackdown on activists during the UPR cycle.
Qatar UPR Submission (2014 PDF)	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=878	Education rights and social policy submission—ties to Item 4.
Amnesty – Dark Side of Migration PDF (pre-World Cup)	https://www.amnesty.org.uk/files/the_dark_side_of_migration_-_spotlight_on_qatars_construction_sector Ahead_of_the_world_cup.pdf	Exposes migrant worker conditions amid World Cup construction.
Guardian – Migrant Worker	https://apnews.com/article/8d913465c3de81c62412dcf5ec07f11c	Reports fatalities—aligns with UNHRC

Deaths (AP)		labor/migrant protection themes.
Guardian – World Cup "Sportswashing" Risks	https://www.theguardian.com/global-development/2024/dec/09/saudi-arabia-2034-world-cup-bid-fifa-human-rights-violations-migrant-workers	Highlights leverage of major events amid rights concerns for Qatar.
Reuters – UNHRC Seat Election Commentary	https://www.reuters.com/world/middle-east/saudi-arabia-narrowly-fails-win-seat-un-human-rights-council-2024-10-09/	Regional context, signaling Council-level pushback on Gulf states.

10 Unique Aspects: Qatar at UNHRC

- 1. Deep UPR Scrutiny on Migrant Labour:** Qatar's reforms regarding exit visas and sponsorship have been consistently criticized by Human Rights Watch and Amnesty International for not being enough. These issues are key points in discussions at the Council.
- 2. Statelessness of the Ghufuran Clan:** HRW has reported on the arbitrary stripping of citizenship, which has raised concerns from the UNHRC regarding nationality rights.
- 3. Criminalising Free Expression & Cyber Surveillance:** The draft laws on cybercrime and media continue to be oppressive, even though there were commitments made during the UPR—this is underscored in reports from HRW and Access Now.
- 4. Arbitrary Arrests of LGBT Community:** HRW has highlighted troubling instances of detention, abuse, and forced "conversion therapy" targeting LGBT individuals in Qatar. This is particularly important for the UNHRC's efforts to protect sexual orientation rights.
- 5. Digital Rights Ahead of UPR 2024:** Access Now identified online surveillance and censorship tied to national development—an evolving HRC issue.
- 6. UNSR-CCR Recognition of Anti-Racism Efforts:** The Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination praised Qatar in 2024, while also addressing some criticisms during Council discussions.
- 7. Labor Reforms vs. Mega-event Abuses:** The collaboration by the ILO on reform stands in sharp contrast to the tragic deaths of construction workers and the exploitation linked to the infrastructure for the World Cup.
- 8. UPR Implementation Gaps Highlighted by OHCHR:** A letter from the High Commissioner in 2021 pointed out that there was a lack of follow-up and implementation regarding the UPR recommendations.
- 9. Sportswashing Debate & Council Visibility:** Major events like FIFA draw global scrutiny at Council level, linking labor rights with reputational politics.
- 10. Rising Council Hesitancy on Gulf Membership:** Qatar's human-rights record, compared with Saudi Arabia's HRC election failure, reveals increasing UN member critical consensus.